7.5 Activities: percentages

← Unit 7.5 · Practice · Games

1. Hundred-square colouring

You need: squared paper, coloured pencils.

How: Draw a 10 × 10 square (100 small squares). He colours 50% red, 25% blue, 10% green and 1% yellow. How much is left white? (14%.) Then make a design or a flag where he chooses the percentages, and you guess them.

Talk about it: "How did you know how many squares 25% was?" "What if the big square had 200 small squares? What would 25% be then?"

2. Percentage bar (strip of paper)

You need: a long strip of paper (about 20 cm), a pencil.

How: Write 0% at the left end and 100% at the right end. Fold in half and mark 50%. Fold again and mark 25% and 75%. Under the strip, write the amounts for a real situation: € 0 to € 80 for a pair of shoes. Read off 50%, 25%, 75%. Then mark 10% (a tenth of the strip) and work out 10% of € 80.

Talk about it: "If the shoes cost € 60 instead, what changes on the strip and what stays the same?"

3. Folder hunt

You need: supermarket or shop folders (*folders*), or a shopping website.

How: Hunt for discounts: "30% korting", "2e halve prijs", "1 + 1 gratis", "25% extra". For each one, work out what you save on one product and what you pay. Make a top three of best deals.

Talk about it: "Is '1 + 1 gratis' the same as 50% korting? When is it not a good deal?" (When you don't need two.)

4. Good deal or not?

You need: paper, a few made-up offers.

How: Write two offers side by side, for example "Shop A: € 30 with 20% korting" and "Shop B: € 28 with 10% korting". He decides which is cheaper and explains why. Then let him invent a pair of offers to trick you.

Talk about it: "Is a bigger percentage always the better deal?"

5. Battery watch

You need: a tablet or phone that shows battery %.

How: Note the battery percentage before and after watching a film or an episode. How many percent did it use? About how many episodes from a full battery?

Talk about it: "100% of my phone battery and 100% of your tablet battery: are they the same amount of power?" (No: 100% is "all of *this* battery".)

6. Supermarket estimate

Play “Supermarket estimate” from GAMES.md with a twist: some items have 25% or 50% korting, and he works out the new price before estimating the total.

Conversation prompts for any day

- “Where did you see a % sign today?”
- “Can something be more than 100%?” (Yes: “125% of last year’s sales”. Talk about what it means.)
- “If 9 out of 10 children like a game, what percentage is that?”